

ABITURPRÜFUNG 2005

GRUNDFACH

ENGLISCH

(HAUPTTERMIN)

Arbeitszeit: 210 Minuten

Hilfsmittel: Einsprachiges Wörterbuch

Wählen Sie von den Aufgaben 1 und 2 **eine** zur Bearbeitung aus. Jede Aufgabe besteht aus den Prüfungsteilen A und B.

In den Prüfungsteilen A und B werden jeweils die inhaltliche und die sprachliche Leistung bewertet.

Rechts neben den Prüfungsteilen A bzw. B steht die jeweils maximal erreichbare Anzahl von Bewertungseinheiten (BE). Die angegebenen BE beinhalten die Bewertung für die inhaltliche **und** die sprachliche Leistung.

Die Anzahl der Wörter ist **für den Prüfungsteil B** zu vermerken.

ÖFFNUNG AM 13. MAI 2005

Task 1

(Text "More Power to You" on pages 5 to 6)

AWorking with the text

Your class intends to discuss alternative energy. You read the text "More Power to You".

Do the tasks, using your own words as far as appropriate.

List the reasons and aims that make people look for energy resources.
Describe the two alternative technologies and give examples of their use.

Explain the meaning of the headline.

31 BE

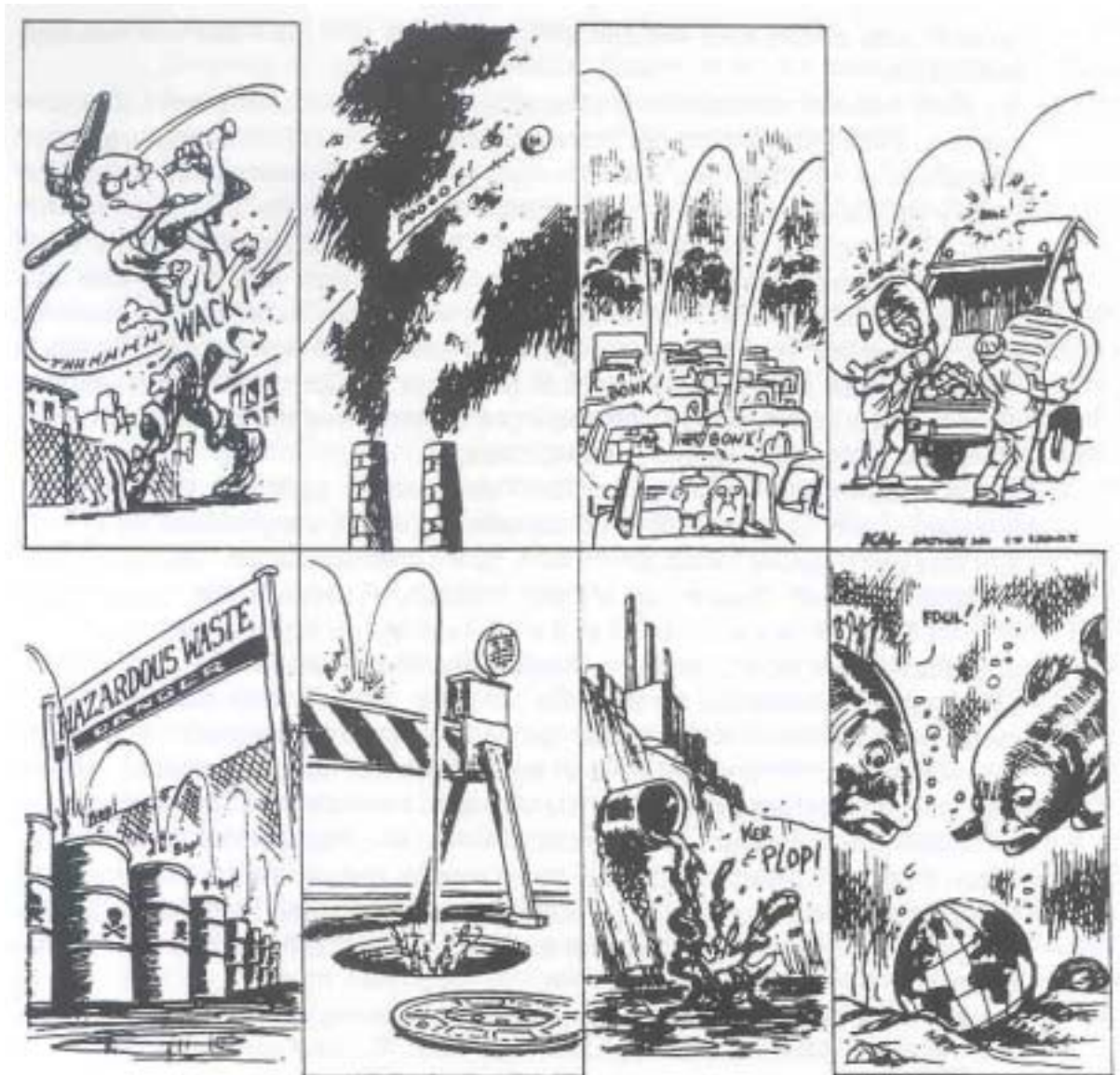
BComposition

Choose **one** of the following tasks.
Write at least 300 words.

1. *More and more people are escaping from the high-tech world and looking for alternative life-styles.*

Comment on this attitude with reference to your own ideas on life.

2. Interpret this cartoon.



Source: *International Herald Tribune*, Oct. 23, 1992

31 BE

Task 2 p.t.o.

Task 2

(Text "A Gift of Gold" on pages 7 to 8)

AWorking with the text

Your English course is dealing with English literature. Your assignment is to write about the story 'A Gift of Gold' by John Keith.

Do the tasks, using your own words as far as appropriate.

Describe the setting of the story.

Explain the dilemmas the protagonists are in.

Evaluate the relationship between them including the decision the mother makes.

31 BE

BComposition

Choose **one** of the following tasks.

Write at least 300 words.

1. *You are a member of the team of students involved in the planning of your graduation ceremony.*

Introduce your concept to the preparatory committee of students and teachers. Write a coherent text in which you support your proposals with arguments.

2. *Several countries favour school uniforms.*

Discuss their possible introduction into German schools.

31 BE

Task 1 Text

More Power to You

Robert K. Lifton is an unlikely front-runner in the tech races. [...] His New York City-based company, Medis Technologies, is one of several World Economic Forum Technology Pioneers developing new ways to deliver clean electricity to homes and cars, not to mention mobile phones and digital cameras. "The market is huge," says Lifton, and he's not exaggerating: he wants to power up the world's billions of portable gadgets.

Electricity, like clean water, is a resource that's often taken for granted. But last summer, consumers on two continents were given a painful reminder of just how fragile electricity supplies can be when blackouts struck Rome, Toronto and much of the northeast U.S. These massive disruptions stranded commuters, defrosted freezers, shut down businesses, and refocused attention on where most of the planet's power comes from: oil- and gas-fired generators and nuclear plants. These sources are not only plagued by creaky¹ infrastructures but pollute the environment, and most consumers feel they pose unacceptable health risks. Entrepreneurs like Lifton are trying to offer an alternative: clean energy from renewable resources that's plentiful—and portable. [...]

The search for alternative energy is nothing new, but the current crop² of innovators is focusing on the long-elusive goal of making clean and sustainable power a mainstream commodity³. The fuel cell, for example—which extracts electricity from the chemical reaction between oxygen and hydrogen—has been around for about 150 years, though its commercial deployment⁴ only began in the 1960s and then only as part of NASA spacecraft. Today, this technology is coming down to earth in places like Tokyo, where the country's first hydrogen-fuel filling station opened in June; in nine European cities from Stockholm to Porto, each operating three hydrogen-fuel-cell buses; and in Iceland, which is trying to create the first fossil-fuel-free "hydrogen economy" by 2030.

When hydrogen and oxygen molecules combine, the reaction produces heat and water. Fuel cells harness this reaction to generate electricity, ideally producing water vapor as the only by-product. One of the attractions of fuel cells is their scalability: they can be big enough to run a factory or small enough to fit under the hood of a car. Medis' innovation is a type of microfuel cell, a power source that's small enough to slip into your pocket. The Medis Power Pack—a portable, wire-free mobile-phone recharger due in shops by the end of next year—will allow users to boot up⁵ their handsets whenever and wherever the need arises.

Phone fading fast at the football match? Just plug it into your Power Pack.[...] Hydrogenics, based in Mississauga, Canada, is also working to bring the fuel cell to market, though its products are big enough to power a car—or a tank. Hydrogenics and General Motors [...] are developing a fuel cell/diesel hybrid for a new generation of 30,000 light tactical vehicles (LTVs) for the U.S. Army, [...]

The military likes fuel cells because they help free vehicles from dependence on vulnerable supply lines, can cut fuel consumption by 20%, and generate enough hydrogen to be self-sufficient in electrical power for up to five hours with the vehicles'

engines off. Fuel cells are also quieter and cooler than traditional portable generators, and therefore harder for the enemy to detect. [...]

45 The devices can also provide soldiers with a much-needed resource, especially when stationed in desert conditions: water. The water vapor from the fuel cells can be recycled for human consumption.

And it's not only the military that's interested. General Motors vice president of research and development Larry Burns says GM itself hopes to sell fuel-cell-powered cars by 2010; [...]

50 What about that other long-promised alternative energy source—solar power? Technology Pioneer Nanosys of Palo Alto, California, thinks solar's day in the sun has finally arrived. The firm is developing tiny photovoltaic cells that can be incorporated into the fabric of roofing materials to provide power to homes and other types of buildings. [...]

55 One prefabricated Nanosys roof could generate enough electricity to run all the appliances in a typical home, including the washing machine, the toaster, the PC and the entertainment center. Electricity generated during the day can be stored in batteries for use at night. [...]

60 With persistence and that old variable, luck, firms like Medis, Hydrogenics and Nanosys could see a big payback for giving power to the people. [...]

By Chris Daniels/Toronto, Unmesh Kher/New York and Chris Taylor/San Francisco

From: TIME, December 15, 2003

Annotations:

- | | |
|------------------------|-------------------------------|
| 1 creaky | old and not in good condition |
| 2 crop | here: group |
| 3 mainstream commodity | an ordinary product |
| 4 deployment (formal) | the use |
| 5 to boot up | to prepare sth. for use |

Task 2

Text

A Gift of Gold

It was the winter of 1937, just after Christmas. The Depression¹ was still going on, but I was in good spirits. At the end of January, I was going to graduate from elementary school. I was just twelve – younger than all the other boys in my class and much smaller. My mother still dressed me in shorts, and when the cold weather came, I wore
 5 woolen knickers² and knee-high socks. [...]

However, for the graduation ceremony, all the boys were expected to dress the same way. They were supposed to wear white shirts, navy-blue knitted ties, and dark-blue wool serge pants. When I asked one or two knickered kids what they were going to do, they said that they were going to show up on graduation day wearing long pants.

10 I waited until a week before graduation before I told my mother. I figured I'd better break the news to her as gently as I could.

I remember that it was a cold Monday afternoon. I had come home from school after crunching my way over the treacherous streets and crosswalk. There were deep ruts and tracks cut into the thick layers of melted and refrozen snow. Inside the house it felt
 15 warm and comforting. I put my heavy coat away in the hall closet, all the while inhaling the tantalizing smell of fish being fried in butter. I went into the kitchen for a glass of milk, one of the few luxuries of life in our house. [...]

"Mom," I said, "about graduation..."

"Yes?" she answered, shuffling the skillet³ on the burner.

20 "They're going to give me the first-prize medal," I said.

Still working over the stove, she looked over her shoulder at me and smiled broadly.

"That's wonderful, Babe. Dad and I will both be there, and we'll be the proudest parents in the place."

She must have seen by the look of my face that something was wrong. She turned her
 25 back to the stove and said, "So?"

"So, I have to get long pants," I said.

It didn't take long to get the answer I expected.

"Babe, we don't have the money for new pants right now," she said very quietly. "You know that."

30 "Okay," I burst out. "Then I won't go to graduation. Plus, I'm running away from home!"

I waited. [...]

"Here," she said. "Cut one of the rolls on the table and make yourself a nice fish sandwich. And if I were you, I wouldn't pack my bags just yet. We'll solve the pants
 35 problem somehow. [...]"

The following Saturday, when my mother said, "Let's go shopping," I knew that she had solved the problem.

Midmorning we bundled up⁴ against the bitter cold that had settled over the city and took the trolley that ran along Westchester Avenue. We got off at Southern Boulevard,
 40 the best shopping street in the East Bronx. Our clothing store was just a couple of blocks away. We had been getting my pants there from Mr. Zenger ever since I could remember. [...]

But first we walked a short way down the boulevard and stopped at a place I had never
 45 noticed before.
 My mother said, "Wait here."
 She opened the door and entered a storefront that looked a little like a bank. I read the
 sign over the door: Home Thrift and Loan.
 She came out about ten minutes later, and we went to the pants store. There Mr.
 50 Zenger fitted me with what was surely the greatest pair of 100 percent pure-wool
 navy-blue serge trousers ever to be had in the whole world. [...]
 The new trousers were wrapped up in brown paper and tied with string. I was holding
 the package tightly under my arm when my mother went to pay Mr. Zenger. I saw her
 take a tiny brown envelope from her purse, tear back the sealed flap, and remove the
 55 contents. There were four brand-new one-dollar bills inside. She carefully unfolded
 them and handed them to Mr. Zenger. He rang up⁵ the sale and gave my mother the
 fifty cents change.
 Sitting next to my mother on the trolley, I had the window seat and looked out for
 most of the ride. About halfway home, there wasn't much to look at rattling over the
 60 Bronx River Bridge, and as I shifted around in my seat to face forward, I glanced
 down at my mother's hands folded across her purse, which was resting on her lap. It
 was then that I saw that the plain gold wedding band that had always circled the ring
 finger on her left hand was no longer there.

By John Keith, *San Jose, California*

From: True Tales of American Life, London, Faber and Faber, 2002

Annotations:

- | | |
|-------------------|--|
| 1 the Depression | period when there was not much business activity
and not many jobs in the 1930s |
| 2 knickers | see: knickerbockers |
| 3 skillet | frying pan |
| 4 to bundle up | to dress warmly |
| 5 to ring up sth. | to enter the price of goods on a cash register |